

Dynamic element

list entry

Semantic elements

device type, data type

Attribute data

elements (above) that are part of an attribute

Data field

attribute, field element, or list entry (see [Data](#))

7.4.1. Encoded Element Processing

When parsing or processing encoded payloads of elements as represented by an encoding layer, such as [TLV format](#), the following general rules apply:

- Unknown elements SHALL be ignored and skipped. This provides forward compatibility with future elements.
- Elements SHALL be present when conveyed according to the element's conformance.
- Elements that are present and conformant SHALL be processed.

7.5. Fabric

A fabric is a set of nodes that interact by accessing data model elements as defined in the [Interaction Model](#). A fabric is a security domain that allows a set of nodes to be identified and communicate within the context of the domain. A node is considered to be 'on' a fabric, when it can be identified and interact in the context of that fabric. An interaction is considered to occur 'on' a fabric, when the interaction occurs in the context of that fabric (see [Accessing Fabric](#)). Each interaction occurs either on a single fabric, or without a fabric context (see [Accessing Fabric](#)).

A node MAY be identified and interact on one or more fabrics.

How a fabric is established and how a node comes to be on a fabric is not defined here and left to the lower layers.

7.5.1. Accessing Fabric

If an interaction is associated with a particular fabric, that fabric is called the "accessing fabric".

An Accessing Fabric is available for an interaction in 3 cases:

- The session is a secure session that was established via [Certificate Authenticated Session Establishment \(CASE\)](#), which causes every interaction over that session to be associated with the fabric identified by the Local Fabric Index in the [Secure Session Context](#).
- After the [AddNOC](#) command is successfully executed within a secure session established over [Passcode-Authenticated Session Establishment \(PASE\)](#), which causes every interaction over that session to thereafter be associated with the fabric created by the command.